

With a new PM in Canada, a chance to mend ties with India

When Justin Trudeau resigned as Prime Minister of Canada in January **amid plummeting approval ratings**, many considered the Liberal Party **dead and buried** ahead of general elections in that country. **His replacement**, Mark Carney, an unelected former central banker, **faced** the **formidable** task of **rescuing** a **flailing** economy and reviving a **fractured** party. Then came Donald Trump. As the US President began his second term, Canadian political **discourse pivoted** towards national pride in response to Trump's **provocations**, which included a suggestion to **annex** Canada as the 51st American state and a **wave** of new **tariffs**. These developments **rallied** Canadians and gave Carney a platform. **Riding** a wave of anti-Trump sentiment, he has led the Liberals to a surprising, **albeit** narrow, electoral victory.

Carney may have emerged as the face of the Liberal Party's **resurrection**, but his challenges are far from over. He must now **confront** serious **economic headwinds** and **navigate** an increasingly unpredictable global **landscape** shaped by Canada's southern neighbour. For India, a significant **aspect** of the election **was** the **downfall** of Jagmeet Singh, leader of the New Democratic Party (NDP), who lost the parliamentary seat he had held since 2019. The NDP supported Trudeau's minority government from 2021 to 2024, but this time failed to **meet** the 12-seat **threshold** required for official party status. With both Singh and Trudeau now **relegated to a back seat**, Carney's election offers a potential **reset** in India-Canada relations, which have been **strained** for one-and-a-half years after Trudeau's **unsubstantiated allegations** against India over the killing of Khalistani separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar.

Nearly two million people of Indian origin live in Canada, and over four lakh Indian students currently study there. Beyond strong people-to-people **ties**, key sectors of **collaboration** include pharmaceuticals, agri-tech, energy and climate change **mitigation**. **Notably**, **trade** between the two countries **has** remained largely unaffected by the diplomatic **fallout**. Canada has identified India as a critical regional partner in its Indo-Pacific Strategy, **citing** a shared interest in **countering** China's expanding influence. Carney's election, therefore, is an opportunity for renewed cooperation — **provided** Canada is willing to **address** India's **legitimate** security concerns on the Khalistan issue. He has already signalled his intent to "rebuild" ties with India, calling the relationship "incredibly important". Whether his government can go beyond the diplomatic **gridlock** of the Trudeau era and **forge** a meaningful **alliance** remains to be seen.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Mend ties** (phrase) – repair relations, restore connection, improve relations, reconcile, reestablish संबंध सुधारना
2. **Amid** (preposition) – during, in the middle of, among, while, throughout के बीच
3. **Plummeting** (adjective) – falling rapidly, dropping sharply, declining fast, nosediving, tumbling तेजी से गिरता हुआ
4. **Approval rating** (noun) – the percentage of respondents to an opinion poll who express approval of someone or something, typically a political figure. अनुमोदन रेटिंग / लोकप्रियता
5. **Dead and buried** (phrase) – finished, over, ended, concluded, done with पूरी तरह समाप्त
6. **Formidable** (adjective) – challenging, daunting, tough, intimidating, powerful कठिन
7. **Rescue** (verb) – save, recover, redeem, retrieve, salvage बचाना
8. **Flailing** (adjective) – struggling, faltering, failing, unsteady, unstable डगमगाता हुआ
9. **Fractured** (adjective) – broken, divided, fragmented, split, damaged विभाजित / टूटा हुआ
10. **Discourse** (noun) – discussion, conversation, dialogue, debate, narrative विमर्श / चर्चा
11. **Pivot** (verb) – shift, turn, change direction, switch, realign दिशा बदलना
12. **Provocation** (noun) – incitement, instigation, trigger, offense, agitation उकसावा
13. **Annex** (verb) – take over, seize, occupy, capture, incorporate जोड़ना
14. **Wave** (verb) – surge, rise, flow, outbreak, burst लहर उठना
15. **Tariff** (noun) – tax, duty, levy, customs charge, trade tax शुल्क / कर
16. **Rally** (verb) – unite, gather, come together, support, mobilize समर्थन जुटाना
17. **Ride** (verb) – take advantage of, exploit, capitalize on, flow with, move with लहर पर सवार होना
18. **Albeit** (adverb) – although, though, even though, however, nonetheless यद्यपि
19. **Resurrection** (noun) – revival, rebirth, renewal, comeback, resurgence पुनरुत्थान / पुनर्जीवन
20. **Confront** (verb) – face, tackle, deal with, combat, oppose सामना करना

21. **Economic headwind** (noun) – it refer to factors that make it more difficult for a company, industry, or economy to achieve its goals आर्थिक प्रतिकूलता
22. **Navigate** (verb) – manage, steer, handle, control, operate संभालना
23. **Landscape** (noun) – environment, setting, scenario, situation, backdrop परिदृश्य
24. **Aspect** (noun) – feature, element, facet, component, side पक्ष / पहलू
25. **Downfall** (noun) – collapse, failure, defeat, ruin, decline पतन
26. **Meet** (verb) – fulfill, achieve, satisfy, reach, attain पूरा करना
27. **Threshold** (noun) – limit, boundary, margin, minimum point, entry level सीमा
28. **Relegate** (verb) – demote, downgrade, dismiss, lower, assign to a lesser role पीछे हटाना
29. **Back seat** (noun) – take or be given a less important position or role.
30. **Reset** (noun) – restart, new beginning, reboot, reestablishment, overhaul पुनः प्रारंभ
31. **Strain** (verb) – stress, damage, burden, weaken, tense तनाव उत्पन्न करना
32. **Unsubstantiated** (adjective) – unproven, unsupported, baseless, unfounded, unverified निराधार
33. **Allegation** (noun) – accusation, claim, charge, assertion, complaint आरोप
34. **Ties** (noun) – relations, connections, links, bonds, associations संबंध
35. **Collaboration** (noun) – partnership, cooperation, alliance, teamwork, joint effort सहयोग
36. **Mitigation** (noun) – reduction, alleviation, moderation, relief, control कम करना
37. **Notably** (adverb) – especially, particularly, significantly, importantly, chiefly विशेष रूप से
38. **Fallout** (noun) – consequence, repercussion, aftereffect, result, outcome दुष्परिणाम
39. **Cite** (verb) – mention, refer to, quote, point out, name हवाला देना
40. **Counter** (verb) – oppose, combat, resist, respond to, neutralize मुकाबला करना
41. **Provided** (preposition) – if, on condition that, as long as, assuming, given that बशर्ते
42. **Address** (verb) – deal with, tackle, respond to, resolve, confront हल करना

43. **Legitimate** (adjective) – valid, justified, lawful, rightful, acceptable वैध / उचित

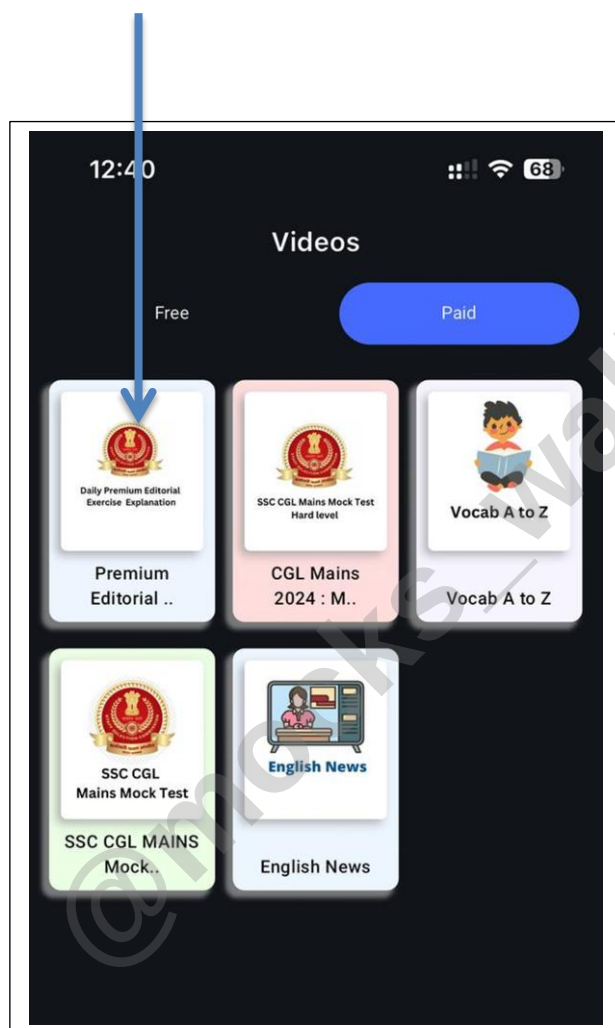
44. **Gridlock** (noun) – deadlock, stalemate, impasse, standstill, jam गतिरोध

45. **Forge** (verb) – build, create, develop, establish, shape बनाना

46. **Alliance** (noun) – partnership, coalition, association, union, pact गठबंधन

@mocks_wallah

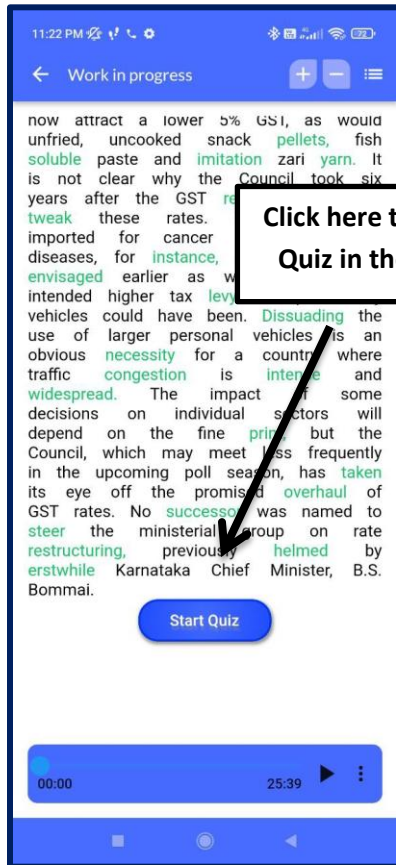
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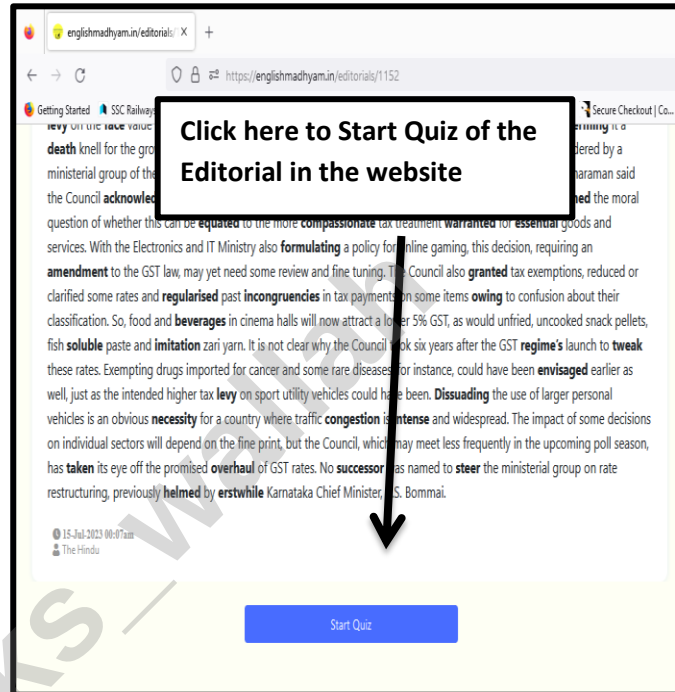
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Justin Trudeau resigned** as Canadian Prime Minister in January amid **declining popularity** and political setbacks.
2. He was replaced by **Mark Carney**, an **unelected ex-central banker**, who faced the task of reviving both the economy and the Liberal Party.
3. **Donald Trump's return** as U.S. President shifted Canadian political focus, with **anti-Trump sentiment boosting Carney's image**.
4. Trump's **provocative statements**, including joking about annexing Canada and imposing tariffs, **rallied Canadian public opinion**.
5. Carney capitalized on this wave and led the **Liberals to a surprising electoral win**, though by a narrow margin.
6. Despite the win, **Carney faces major economic and geopolitical challenges**, especially in dealing with the U.S.
7. A key outcome for India was the **defeat of Jagmeet Singh**, NDP leader and Trudeau ally, who lost his seat.
8. The **NDP's poor performance** (below 12 seats) removed it from official party status, weakening the pro-Khalistan lobby in Parliament.
9. Singh and Trudeau stepping back offers **a potential reset in India-Canada relations**, strained by Trudeau's 2023 allegations against India.
10. The relationship soured after **unsubstantiated claims** that India was involved in the killing of **Khalistani separatist Hardeep Singh Nijjar**.
11. Canada hosts **nearly 2 million Indian-origin people** and over **400,000 Indian students**, underscoring deep people-to-people ties.
12. Despite political tensions, **bilateral trade and cooperation** in areas like **pharma, agri-tech, and energy** remained resilient.
13. Canada's **Indo-Pacific Strategy identifies India** as a key regional partner, especially for **countering China's influence**.
14. **Carney has expressed a desire to rebuild ties**, acknowledging India as an "incredibly important" partner.
15. A true reset depends on **Canada addressing India's security concerns** around Khalistan and moving past Trudeau-era gridlock.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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